

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills to keep suppliers and customers fully informed.



Effective team-working for coordinating the work of every member of the supply chain.



Strong leadership abilities to motivate a range of people—from truck drivers to managers.



Sharp analytical skills and a logical approach for effective scheduling and stock control.



The ability to use computerized systems efficiently for tracking goods, supply levels, and costs.



LOGISTICS CONSULTANT Provides specialized services, often on a freelance basis, helping firms to plan and set up supply chains and advises on global transportation networks.



QUALITY MANAGER Focuses on minimizing shipment errors, delays, and goods damaged in transit. Quality managers also review the supply chain to identify areas that can be improved.



Government and the military rely on logistics managers for moving personnel and supplies.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **TRANSPORTATION PLANNER** *see pp. 218–219*
- ▶ **CRANE OPERATOR** Uses a crane to load containers and items of cargo on and off ships, trucks, and trains, to be transported locally or around the globe.
- ▶ **HUMANITARIAN AID WORKER** Manages the collection, transportation, and delivery of food, clothing, medicines, and other vital supplies to people following natural disasters or during conflicts.
- ▶ **PURCHASING MANAGER** Buys in any product or service required for a business to help it to carry out its core activities.

AT A GLANCE



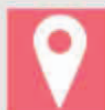
YOUR INTERESTS Mathematics • IT • Planning • Business studies and efficiency • Management • Geography • Languages



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Most logistics manager positions require a degree, but it is possible to start as an assistant and work your way up.



LIFESTYLE Large logistics firms operate around the clock, so logistics managers may be required to work full-time hours in shifts.



LOCATION Mostly office-based, but logistics managers may also need to visit warehouses and suppliers during the working week.



THE REALITIES Travel, sometimes to international destinations, is common. Long hours are often required, but the rewards can be generous.